# How to Sell Your Home in Denver

What today's market means for your price, the prep that pays off in older Denver homes, what it costs to sell in Colorado, and how the process runs from listing to closing.



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# The Market You're Selling Into

Denver has shifted from a seller's market to a balanced one. There are more homes for sale than at any point in years, buyers are taking their time, and price reductions are common. Homes still sell, and most sell close to their asking price. The difference is that buyers now punish overpricing by waiting.

| 13,567 | 4.76 | 32 | 98.45% |
|---|---|---|---|
| active listings, the most for a September since 2011 | months of inventory across the metro | median days in MLS overall; 21 for homes over $1M | of list price, the median sold-to-list ratio |

Denver metro, September 2026. Source: DMAR October 2026 Market Trends Report.

Two details matter most if you're selling in central Denver. First, homes over $1 million are moving faster than the market as a whole, with a median of 21 days in the MLS. Well-located, well-presented homes in neighborhoods like Washington Park and Bonnie Brae still draw serious buyers. Second, the Denver Metro Association of Realtors notes that Colorado recently ranked first in the nation for price cuts. A price cut tells buyers the original price was wrong, and they negotiate accordingly.

> *"Anyone looking to sell right now needs a good reason to. Buyers are taking their time and looking for deals, so the sellers who do well are the ones who price and prepare for that from day one."*



Chris Nowakiwsky, Broker Associate

# Price It for Today's Buyers

Pricing is the decision that matters most, and it's where sellers lose the most money in a slower market. Buyers search by price range and watch new listings closely. Your home gets its biggest wave of attention in the first two weeks. If the price is too high, those buyers move on, and the ones who come later see a home that has been sitting.

## Price for Where the Market Is Going

Comparable sales from six months ago reflect a busier market. The better guide is what's competing with you today: active listings, recent price reductions, and homes that went under contract in the last 30 to 60 days. Price your home against that, not against what a neighbor got last spring.

### Mind the Search Brackets

Buyers set price filters in round numbers. A home listed at $1,010,000 never appears for the buyer whose search tops out at $1,000,000. Listing just under a bracket, such as $995,000, puts your home in front of both groups.

### Why Automated Estimates Miss in Central Denver

In older neighborhoods, an original 1920s bungalow and a fully updated one can sit on the same block and sell hundreds of thousands of dollars apart. Lot width, alley access, updated sewer and electrical, and whether the lot has scrape value all move the price. Online estimates can't see any of that. A pricing analysis built from homes buyers actually compared yours against will.

### If You Need to Reduce

If the first two to three weeks bring showings but no offers, the price is usually the issue. One meaningful reduction works better than several small ones. Small cuts rarely bring new buyers in, and each one signals that more are coming.

## Prep That Pays in Older Denver Homes

Many homes in central Denver are 60 to 100 years old. Buyers know it, and so do their inspectors. The goal of prep is to remove surprises before a buyer finds them, because problems found during inspection become negotiations on your price.

### Worth Doing Before You List

- **Sewer scope.** Many older homes still have original clay sewer lines that tree roots crack over time. Buyers in central Denver almost always scope the line. Doing it first lets you fix or price a problem on your terms.
- **Radon test.** Radon levels are high across much of Colorado and buyers routinely test for it. If you have a mitigation system, share the paperwork.
- **Roof and hail.** Front Range hail is hard on roofs, and buyers' insurers ask about roof age. Gather your roof's age, any claims and any replacement records.
- **Electrical and furnace.** Homes from the early 1900s may still have older wiring. A licensed electrician's report and a furnace service record answer questions before they're asked.
- **Paint, light and landscaping.** Fresh neutral paint, bright bulbs, clean windows and a tidy front yard cost little and show up in every listing photo.

### Usually Not Worth It

Large remodels right before a sale rarely return what they cost, and they delay your listing. Buyers who want a new kitchen would rather choose it themselves. Fix what's broken, refresh what's tired, and put the rest into presentation.

### Disclosures to Prepare

Colorado sellers must disclose known material defects, and most use the Colorado Real Estate Commission's Seller's Property Disclosure form. If your home was built before 1978, federal law also requires a lead-based paint disclosure. Starting these early means fewer surprises once you're under contract.

## When to List

Spring is still the busiest season. Zillow's research finds that, nationally, homes listed in late May sell for about 1.7% more than average. In Denver, families moving before the school year make March through June the strongest stretch.

Fall and winter have advantages too. Fewer homes compete with yours, and the buyers still shopping in November and December are usually serious about moving. As DMAR put it in its October report, buyers who stay in the market late in the year face less competition than at any other time.

In practice, your reason for moving should set the timing more than the season. If you need to sell, a well-priced home sells in any month. If you're flexible, spending the winter on prep and listing in early spring is a strong plan.

## From Listing to Closing in Colorado

Here's how a typical sale with a financed buyer runs. Every deadline lives in the Colorado Contract to Buy and Sell Real Estate, and missing one has real consequences, so it pays to know them before you accept an offer.

1

**Price and Prepare**

1 to 4 weeks before listing

Pricing analysis, pre-listing inspections, repairs, cleaning, staging and photography. Your seller's disclosure gets drafted here too.

2 **Go Live and Show**

Weeks 1 to 3

Your home hits the MLS and every major home search site. Most of your showing activity happens in the first two weeks.

3 **Review Offers and Sign a Contract**

Day 0 of the contract

Compare more than price: loan type, down payment, earnest money, inspection terms, closing date, and any request for you to pay toward the buyer's costs.

4 **Inspection and Resolution**

Usually days 7 to 14

The buyer inspects and may send an Inspection Objection. You negotiate repairs, a credit or a price change, or the buyer may walk away by the deadline.

5 **Appraisal, Title and Loan**

Usually days 14 to 30

The lender's appraiser values the home, the title company clears title, and the buyer's loan moves toward final approval.

6 **Closing**

Usually 30 to 45 days after signing

You sign the deed at the title company, your loan is paid off, and the proceeds are wired to you. If you need time after closing, Colorado's standard Post-Closing Occupancy Agreement lets you stay for up to 60 days.

# What It Costs to Sell a Home in Colorado

Colorado has no state transfer tax, only a small documentary fee of one cent per $100 of the price, which is $100 on a $1,000,000 home. Your main costs are below.

- **Real estate brokerage fees.** These are negotiable and set in your listing agreement. Since August 2024, compensation for the buyer's agent is negotiated separately. You can choose to offer it, the buyer can ask for it in their offer, or the buyer can pay their agent directly.
- **Owner's title insurance.** In Colorado, the seller customarily pays for the buyer's owner's title policy. It's priced on the sale price, and your title company quotes the exact amount.

- **Closing fee.** The title company's fee for running the closing, typically split between buyer and seller.
- **Property tax credit.** Colorado property taxes are paid a year behind. At closing, you credit the buyer for the taxes your home has built up from January 1 to the closing date.
- **Mortgage payoff.** Your remaining loan balance, plus any home equity line, is paid off from the proceeds.
- **HOA fees.** If you have an HOA, expect a status letter fee and sometimes a transfer fee.
- **Concessions and repairs.** In today's market, many buyers ask for credits toward closing costs or a mortgage rate buydown, or for repairs after inspection. Plan for some room here.

# Estimate Your Net Proceeds

Enter your numbers to see roughly what you'd walk away with. The starting values are examples for a $1,000,000 central Denver home. Change any of them.

> Run your own numbers with the interactive calculator at findhomesarounddenver.com/sell.

# Taxes When You Sell

If the home is your primary residence and you've owned and lived in it for at least two of the last five years, federal law lets you exclude up to $250,000 of profit from capital gains tax, or $500,000 if you're married and file jointly. Most central Denver sellers who meet that test owe no federal tax on the sale.

Profit above those limits is taxed as a capital gain, and Colorado taxes it as regular income at the state's flat rate. Improvements you've made over the years, like a new roof, a remodel or a sewer line replacement, raise your cost basis and lower your taxable gain, so keep those receipts.

As of October 2026, the limits are unchanged. Bills in Congress to raise or remove them have not become law. A tax professional can confirm how the rules apply to you, especially for rentals, second homes or homes you've lived in for less than two years.

# Seller FAQ

## How Much Does It Cost to Sell a House in Colorado?

Colorado sellers typically spend about 6% to 10% of the sale price in total, though it varies with the brokerage fees you negotiate and any credits you give the buyer. Beyond brokerage fees, the main costs are the owner's title insurance policy, your share of the closing fee, and a credit to the buyer for property taxes. Colorado has no state transfer tax.

## What Closing Costs Do Sellers Pay in Colorado?

Sellers customarily pay for the buyer's owner's title insurance policy, part of the title company's closing fee, any HOA status letter and transfer fees, and a prorated property tax credit because Colorado taxes are paid a year behind. The documentary fee is one cent per $100 of the price. Who pays what can be negotiated in the contract.

## How Much Tax Do You Pay When Selling a House in Colorado?

Often none. If it's your primary home and you've owned and lived in it for two of the last five years, you can exclude up to $250,000 of gain, or $500,000 for married couples filing jointly. Gain above that is taxed federally as a capital gain, and Colorado taxes it as income at its flat rate. Colorado has no state transfer tax on home sales.

## Is It a Good Time to Sell a House in Denver Right Now?

It's a fair market rather than a hot one. Inventory is the highest it has been in years and buyers are selective, but homes that are priced right and well prepared still sell, usually close to their asking price. Homes over $1 million are selling faster than the market overall. If you have a good reason to move, there's no need to wait, but your pricing has to match today's buyers.

## What Is the Best Month to Sell a House in Denver?

Spring, especially April through early June, draws the most buyers and the strongest prices. Late fall and winter bring fewer buyers but also far less competition, and the buyers who are looking tend to be serious. A well-priced home sells in any season.

## How Long Does It Take to Sell a House in Denver?

In September 2026, the median home in the Denver metro spent 32 days in the MLS before going under contract, and homes over $1 million spent 21. Closing then takes another 30 to 45 days for a buyer using a mortgage. Plan on two to three months from listing to closing, plus a few weeks of prep beforehand.

### Do Sellers Have to Pay the Buyer's Agent in Colorado?

No. Since August 2024, buyer's agent compensation is negotiated separately from the listing agreement. You can offer to pay it, a buyer can request it in their offer, or the buyer can pay their own agent. Offering it can widen your pool of buyers, so it's a strategic decision to make with your listing agent.

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### Can I Stay in My Home After Closing?

Yes, if the buyer agrees. Colorado's standard Post-Closing Occupancy Agreement lets a seller stay for up to 60 days after closing when the buyer plans to live in the home, usually for a daily or monthly rent and a deposit. It's common when sellers are buying their next home at the same time.

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# Questions? Let's Talk.

Every move is different. If you'd like to talk through your plans, your neighborhood or your numbers, I'm happy to help, with no pressure and no obligation.




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